

RELIGIOUS PLURALISM AND THE PROBLEM OF ABSOLUTE TRUTH

FOUR AXES OF DIVERSITY → EXCLUSIVISM-INCLUSIVISM-PLURALISM → JOHN HICK → VEDĀNTIC MODELS → JAIN MANY-SIDEDNESS → TOLERANCE AND RELIGIOUS FREEDOM

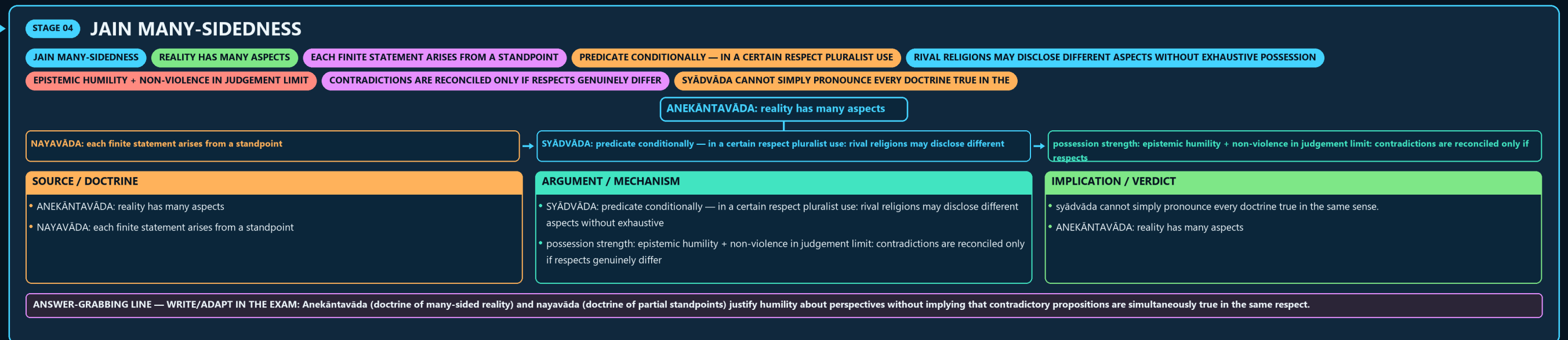
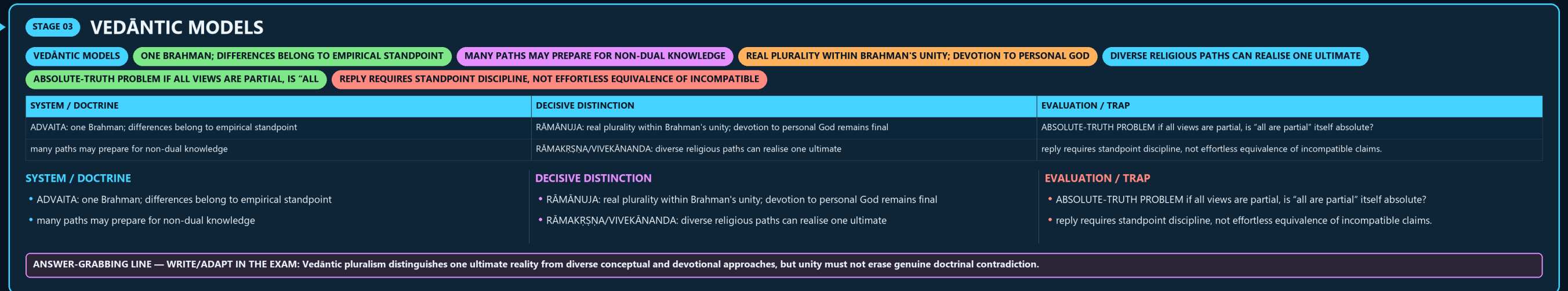
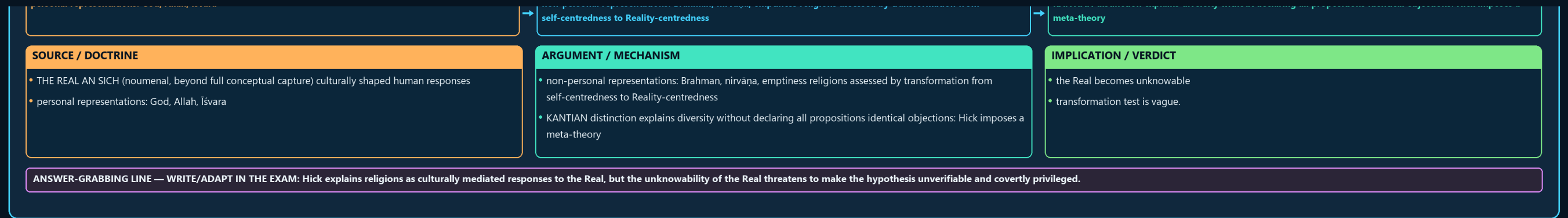
Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g12 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles





dialogue: reciprocal reason-giving freedom: belief, practice, change of religion, non-belief, association

LIMITS coercion

harm to rights may be regulated but offence or theological falsity alone is not sufficient

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- TOLERANCE: refrain from coercion despite disagreement respect: recognise equal standing
- dialogue: reciprocal reason-giving freedom: belief, practice, change of religion, non-belief, association

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- LIMITS coercion
- harm to rights may be regulated but offence or theological falsity alone is not sufficient ground for suppression

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- principled pluralism protects persons and conscience, not every practice from criticism.
- TOLERANCE: refrain from coercion despite disagreement respect: recognise equal standing

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious freedom protects belief, practice, change and non-belief, but public restriction is justified only by neutral, proportionate protection of rights and order.

06

STAGE 06

CONFLICT, UNIFICATION AND DEEP DISAGREEMENT

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CONFLICT SOURCES

EXCLUSIVE REVELATION

SACRED HISTORY

GRIEVANCE RESPONSES

COMMON ETHICAL CORE

COMPARATIVE THEOLOGY

LEGAL NEUTRALITY

CONFLICT SOURCES: exclusive revelation

sacred history

grievance responses: syncretism

common ethical core

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CONFLICT SOURCES: exclusive revelation
- sacred history
- grievance responses: syncretism

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- common ethical core
- comparative theology
- legal neutrality

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DEEP DISAGREEMENT persists because standards of evidence are tradition-shaped humility != relativism: give reasons, admit fallibility, seek overlap,
- preserve dissent objections to pluralism: self-refuting, imperial meta-theory, doctrinal dilution reply: modest pluralism can defend equal civic respect
- without equalising every truth claim.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — DEEP DISAGREEMENT persists because standards of evidence are tradition-shaped humility != relativism: give reasons, admit fallibility, seek overlap, preserve dissent objections to pluralism: self-refuting, imperial meta-theory, doctrinal dilution reply: modest pluralism can defend equal civic respect without equalising every truth claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Deep religious disagreement persists because evidence is interpreted through rival frameworks, yet rational dialogue remains possible through internal critique, shared reasons and epistemic humility.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

DEFINE AXIS

MAP EXCLUSIVISM/INCLUSIVISM/PLURALISM

EXPLAIN HICK EXACTLY

COMPARE ADVAITA/RĀMĀNUJA/JAIN ANEKĀNTA

TEST ABSOLUTE-TRUTH OBJECTION

MOVE FROM METAPHYSICAL DIVERSITY TO TOLERANCE/FREEDOM WITH LIMITS

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

DEFINE axis → map exclusivism/inclusivism/pluralism → explain Hick exactly

compare Advaita/Rāmānuja/Jain anekānta → test absolute-truth objection

move from metaphysical diversity to tolerance/freedom with limits

qualified conclusion

CLOSE: defensible pluralism is neither “all religions say the same” nor relativism

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE axis → map exclusivism/inclusivism/pluralism → explain Hick exactly
- compare Advaita/Rāmānuja/Jain anekānta → test absolute-truth objection

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- move from metaphysical diversity to tolerance/freedom with limits
- qualified conclusion

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLOSE: defensible pluralism is neither “all religions say the same” nor relativism
- it combines truth-seeking, fallibilism, transformative comparison and equal civic liberty.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pluralism need not deny absolute truth; it denies exhaustive possession of truth by any finite perspective and therefore supports a bounded, non-relativist openness.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

EXCLUSIVISM MAKES ONE TRADITION'S DECISIVE TRUTH/SALVATION CLAIM UNIQUELY VALID

INCLUSIVISM GRANTS TRUTH OR SALVATION BEYOND IT WHILE INTERPRETING

EXCLUSIVISM APPEALS TO DETERMINATE REVELATION AND NON-CONTRADICTION.

INCLUSIVISM ADDS UNIVERSALITY OF DIVINE GRACE WHILE PRESERVING NORMATIVE

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Doctrine statement.
- Exclusivism makes one tradition's decisive truth/salvation claim uniquely valid
- inclusivism grants truth or salvation beyond it while interpreting that success through the home tradition.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Argument.
- Exclusivism appeals to determinate revelation and non-contradiction.
- Inclusivism adds universality of divine grace while preserving normative priority.
- Presupposition. CAUTION: One revelation has privileged warrant, and salvation can be specified independently enough to compare traditions.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Distinction. Inclusivism is not pluralism: others are included on terms set by the privileged tradition.
- Canonical example. Rahner's "anonymous Christian" is a standard inclusivist model.
- Objection → reply.
- CAUTION: Inclusivism appears patronising.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.